

Standard laptop orders

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

SCENARIO

Requesting, approving, and receiving a configured standard laptop



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Steps

What does the person (or group) typically experience?

Need a laptop

An employee needs a standard laptop and decides to raise a request

Open Service Catalog

Opens ServiceNow, clicks All and searches for Service Catalog

Choose Hardware

In Service Catalog, clicks the Hardware category

Find Standard Laptop

Scrolls to the Standard Laptop item and clicks it

Order Now

Clicks Order Now to place the request

Request submitted

Order status appears with a Request Number

Approval requested

The request record lists the approval in its Approvers section

Request approved

Approver right-clicks the approval record and selects Approve

Flow triggers

The 'Standard laptop task' flow (Service Catalog trigger) runs automatically as System user

Catalog task created

Flow creates a Catalog Task on the requested item: 'Laptop need to Configured'

Assigned to Hardware

Task Assignment group is set to Hardware; Approval field set to Approved

Laptop configured

On arrival, the Hardware team configures the laptop

Check order status

Employee clicks the Request Number, then opens the Requested Item

Review catalog task

In Catalog tasks, opens the task to see status, short description and assigned group

Receive laptop

Employee receives a configured laptop with minimal waiting

Record kept

Request, requested item and task remain on the request record

Flow serves every order

The flow is attached to the Standard Laptop item, so future orders follow the same path

Feedback

Employee could rate how smooth the order and wait were (not in project scope)

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Interactions

What interactions do they have at each step along the way?

People: Who do they see or talk to?

Places: Where are they?

Things: What digital touchpoints or physical objects would they use?

ServiceNow in the browser

ServiceNow: All > Service Catalog

Service Catalog > Hardware category

Standard Laptop catalog item page

'Order Now' button on the item page

Order Status page with the Request Number

Request record > Approvers section. People: the approver

Approval record > right-click > Approve. People: the approver

Flow Designer flow runs in the background. No employee action needed

Requested Item record > Catalog tasks section

Catalog Task field: Assignment group = Hardware

People: Hardware team. Things: the physical laptop

Request Number link; Requested Item record

Catalog Task record in ServiceNow

People: Hardware team. Hand-over method not defined in project

Request record in ServiceNow

Flow assigned via Maintain Items > Process engine

Channel not defined (e.g. a portal survey)

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Goals & motivations

At each step, what is a person's primary goal or motivation? ("Help me..." or "Help me avoid...")

Help me get a laptop without a long process

Help me find where to raise this request

Help me reach hardware requests quickly

Help me find the standard laptop option

Help me place my order with minimal effort

Help me know my request was received

Help me get my request approved

Help me get approval without chasing anyone

Help me avoid manual follow-ups

Help me make sure a configuration task exists

Help me make sure the right team owns it

Help me get my laptop configured promptly on arrival

Help me see where my request stands

Help me confirm someone owns the task

Help me start work with a ready laptop, no long wait

Help me find my past requests

Help me get the same smooth experience next time

Help me say what could be better

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Positive moments

What steps does a typical person find enjoyable, productive, fun, motivating, delightful, or exciting?

Standard Laptop is a ready-made item under Hardware

Ordering takes a single Order Now click

A Request Number is shown straight after ordering

Task is created automatically; nobody has to remember to raise it

Task reaches the Hardware group with no manual assignment

Laptop is configured promptly on arrival, so less waiting

Status, short description and assigned group are visible

Seamless experience with timely configuration

One flow handles every standard laptop order

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Negative moments

What steps does a typical person find frustrating, confusing, angering, costly, or time-consuming?

Employee may not know to look under Service Catalog > Hardware

Approval needs a person to act; the request waits until they do

Before automation, configuration was prone to oversight or delay

Task text is one fixed phrase, with no requesters or laptop details

Any delay here means the user waits, the original source of frustration

Employee must open several records to see status; no update is described

Request, Requested Item and Catalog task are separate records to click through

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Areas of opportunity

How might we make each step better? What ideas do we have? What have others suggested?

How might we link Standard Laptop directly from the portal home?

How might we remind the approver while a request is pending?

How might we add requester and laptop details to the task description?

How might we notify the employee on approval and on completion?

How might we show task status on the request page itself?

How might we tell the employee when and where to collect the laptop?

How might we capture quick feedback on wait time?